

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 9 6 3

♥ 8 5

♦ 9 6

♣ A J 9 3

♠ A 7 5 2

♥ Q 10 9

♦ K Q 7

♣ 8 5 4



♠ J 8 4

♥ 7 4 2

♦ J 10 5 4

♣ K Q 10

♠ 10

♥ A K J 6 3

♦ A 8 3 2

♣ 7 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			

4 ♥ by South

yourself in Dummy's seat and pretend you are playing 4 ♥ from that side of the table.

South is to play 4 ♥. West leads the ♠K, taken by dummy's ♠A.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 4

One possibility is to pull trumps and play for a 3-3 ♦ split. This will occur about 36% of the time. While you may not know all the bridge probabilities, it is useful to remember that an EVEN number of cards (6 in this case) will probably NOT split EVENLY (3-3 in this case). So, let's try to improve on 36%.

You could play to pull just two rounds of trumps, then ruff your fourth ♦, hoping that the defender with the third trump also has the fourth ♦. These odds are tougher to figure, but it doesn't look good, does it?

If you don't see a better Plan than these two, just put

Aha! From dummy's viewpoint you have no ♦ losers! You still have the 3 ♣ losers, but now you also have 3 ♠ losers. How does this help you?

You can now ruff all 3 of those ♠ losers in the South hand. Like this: Win the ♠A and ruff a ♠ with the ♥A. Play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥9. Ruff another ♠ with the ♥K. Play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥10. Ruff dummy's last ♠ with your last trump, the ♥J. Enter dummy with a ♦ and pull the last trump with the ♥Q.

You win 3 ♦s, 3 ♥s in dummy, the ♠A and 3 ♠ ruffs in your hand. Total: 10 tricks.

This is a Dummy Reversal. You take some ruffs in the long-trump hand, and pull trumps with the short-trump hand.

For a Dummy Reversal to work you usually have to have a decent trump split.

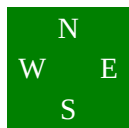
Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 7
♥ 7 2
♦ K Q J 9
♣ K 9 6 3

♠ A 6 3
♥ J 10 8 3
♦ 8 7 5 2
♣ 8 4



♠ K Q J 2
♥ A
♦ 10 6 4 3
♣ 10 7 5 2

♠ 8 5 4
♥ K Q 9 6 5 4
♦ A
♣ A Q J

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			

4 ♥ by South
you play the ♣J. A defender wins the ♣K and attacks ♠s. Too late, you are in the driver's seat. Win the ♠A, play a ♣ to your ♣Q, and then play the ♣A, discarding a ♠ from dummy. You lose the Ace of trumps, one ♣, and just one ♠.

Leading a ♠ to dummy for a ♣ finesse might have worked.

Trying to sneak into dummy with a trump might have worked.

Playing a ♣ from your hand at the second trick **WILL** work.

South is to play 4 ♥. West leads the ♦K.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=1 Total = 4

You could go to dummy with the ♠A and try a finesse for the ♣K. If it works, no more ♣ loser. But if it fails the bad guys will cash a couple of ♠s and even you can't dodge the Ace of trumps.

Or, you could try to get to dummy with a trump to the ♥J so you could make the ♣ finesse while dummy still keeps the ♠A. Of course the defenders would probably take the first ♥ and then knock out your ♠A. When the ♣ finesse failed, same bad result. What else might you try?

Forget the ♣ finesse. Forget pulling trumps. Win the first trick and play any ♣ from your hand. Let's say